

- **Create a Clean Restore point**

The first thing that you should do after installing your OS is to create a Restore point. This makes sure that you don't have to install Windows and start again afresh the next time you encounter a problem. Go to Control Panel > Recovery > Configure System Restore. Select the Create button and follow the onscreen wizard to create a System Restore point. If the Create button isn't working, Click the 'Configure' button and check 'Turn on system protection' radio button.

- **Install an Antivirus and Antispyware**

All Windows 10 computers come with Windows Defender, a built in anti-virus which offers a baseline protection to your system. Though a solid antivirus, it's not good enough and cannot stand against other industry leaders. There are a number of paid and free antiviruses in the market, enough to boggle your mind. Though each has its own set of pros and cons, one cannot go wrong with Kaspersky's security suite if you want the best paid protection. Avast and Avira are two good free antiviruses. Most paid security suites have their own anti spyware but if you are using a free version, chances are you'll have to install another program to protect your machine from spyware. MalwareBytes Anti-Malware and SpyBot Search and Destroy are two good free options available.

- **Keep UAC turned on**

User Account Control, a built in feature of windows, provides an additional layer of security to your computer by notifying you whenever a suspicious program tries to make changes to the system. The UAC is turned on by default. You can change its intensity by going to Control Panel > User Accounts > User Account Control Setting and then moving the slider.

If you followed the above steps, then your machine is completely virus free and secure – as of now. But if you want to keep it this way you need to use common sense and be proactive. Keep in mind the following things to keep your Windows machine safe and secure:

- Only download files from trusted sources and scan them before opening.
- Ignore Unknown, Spam or shady emails telling you about the money your great great grandfather left you or an all expense paid trip to Spain you won.
- Scan every external storage device you connect to the computer before accessing it.